

User input
Scientific question + authorized data + fixed scope

Freeze the research contract
Decision Contract + Prior-exposure Audit + stopping rules

Build the versioned search map
Mechanism inventory + finite coverage cells + selection families

Design the next coverage test
Observable + sample + falsifier + inference plan

Round record
Result + caveat + versions
Next open cells

Run one coverage round
Screen -> deep test -> falsify; append every choice to the ledger

Promotion audit
Comparable selection family
Complete path + verification status

Null triage
Validity + sensitivity
Mechanism-observable fit

This result
candidate evidence?

Cannot continue
New data or assumption
scope change needed

Can continue
Version the map; choose
another open cell

Not enough
Keep exploratory
continue validation

Enough
Eligible for
closure audit

Final report
Closure audit: inventory saturation + coverage + ledger + complete selection path
Apply Decision Contract: leading / tie / inconclusive / none / incomplete